

N09 SPECIAL DIETS | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Provide alternative food choices to individuals with dietary restrictions, food allergies or intolerances, and label common food allergens.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the provision of meal alternatives and food allergen labeling.

Issue : Individuals with food allergies, intolerances or dietary restrictions may encounter difficulty in finding suitable meal options outside of the home setting. The World Allergy Organization reports that the prevalence of food allergies is increasing in countries around the world.¹ A growing number of individuals are also omitting certain ingredients or following special diets for a variety of personal, health, social and environmental reasons.² Such dietary exclusion or restriction may have nutritional consequences and lead to a nutritionally deficient diet.^{3,4} Dietary guidelines increasingly recognize a variety of healthy eating patterns, such as the Mediterranean-style and vegetarian eating patterns, that can help ensure an individual's diet is both nutritionally adequate and enjoyable.⁵

Solutions : Meal alternatives for common food allergies or intolerances and dietary restrictions can help accommodate individual dietary preferences and ensure the availability of meal options and balanced meals for everyone. Alternatives can minimize the stress and worry associated with food and dietary restrictions. Suitable meal options can also minimize the risk of individuals consuming potentially harmful foods. To further reduce barriers to special dietary needs, alternative food items can be offered at the same or similar price as standard items. Ingredient transparency through accurate food allergen labeling can help individuals identify and avoid potential allergens.

PART 1 ACCOMMODATE SPECIAL DIETS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Meals with main dishes are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and include at least one option that meets the following requirements:

- a. Does not contain peanut and tree nuts.
- b. Does not contain gluten and wheat.
- c. Does not contain soy.
- d. Does not contain sesame.
- e. Does not contain animal products, including seafood, dairy, and eggs.

PART 2 LABEL FOOD ALLERGENS AND INTOLERANCES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner and all foods and beverages are clearly labeled at point-of-decision (e.g., on packaging, menus, signage) to indicate if they contain the following common food allergens and intolerances:⁶

- a. Peanut.
- b. Fish.
- c. Shellfish.
- d. Soy.
- e. Milk.
- f. Egg.
- g. Wheat.
- h. Tree nuts.
- i. Sesame.
- j. Gluten.

REFERENCES

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